# DSN Bootcamp Qualification Hackathon 2026 ML Track

## Competition Brief

**Track:** Machine Learning (ML)

**Goal:** Build a machine learning model that predicts total sales for a given product at a given store, based on what's known about the product and the outlet it's sold in. Your rank on the leaderboard is one of the inputs used to select participants for the DSN AI Bootcamp.

DSN Bootcamp Qualification Hackathon 2026 ML Track | Kaggle

### Project Brief

DSN Mart operates a chain of stores across Nigeria, from small corner shops to flagship hypermarkets, spread across major urban centres, state capitals, and smaller towns. Like any growing retail business, DSN Mart wants to understand what drives sales at the product level across its different store formats and locations, so it can plan stock, pricing, and store investment more intelligently.

You've been given a snapshot of historical product-store sales records and asked to build a model that predicts total sales for a given product at a given store, based on what's known about the product and the outlet it's sold in.

This challenge is being used as the qualifying hackathon for the DSN AI Bootcamp — your rank on the leaderboard is one of the inputs used to select participants for the bootcamp, though participation alone does not guarantee selection.

### Instructions

Participants will:

- Explore and understand the provided product-store sales dataset.
- Analyse factors that may influence product sales across different stores and locations.
- Clean and preprocess the data.
- Perform exploratory data analysis (EDA) to identify useful patterns.
- Engineer relevant features from the available product and store information.
- Build and evaluate machine learning models.
- Generate predictions for the required test data.

**Evaluation:** For each row in test.csv, predict the value of total sales. This is a regression problem, scored using Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE) — lower is better.

## Qualification for the DSN AI Bootcamp

This is not just a learning exercise; it is a qualification hackathon for the DSN AI Bootcamp.

Participants' leaderboard performance will be one of the inputs considered when selecting candidates for the Bootcamp. Therefore, participants are encouraged to focus on both the quality of their solution and their understanding of the problem.

**Important:** Participation in the hackathon does not automatically guarantee selection for the DSN AI Bootcamp. Your performance and rank will contribute to your chances of being selected.

## What Participants Are Expected to Demonstrate

The hackathon provides an opportunity for participants to demonstrate their ability to:

**Understand → Analyse → Model → Predict → Communicate**

Success will depend not only on building a model, but also on applying sound data science practices to a real-world business problem.

## Submission

Submit your predictions to the competition platform and compete on the leaderboard.

**Assignment link:** [www.kaggle.com/competitions/dsn-bootcamp-qualification-hackathon-2026-ml-track/overview/citation](www.kaggle.com/competitions/dsn-bootcamp-qualification-hackathon-2026-ml-track/overview/citation)